

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 8
 ♥ A 6 4 3
 ♦ 8 5 4 3
 ♣ A K J

♠ A K J 7 4

♥ 8 7

♦ A 7 6

♣ Q 5 4



♠ 5 3

♥ K Q J 10

♦ Q J 10 2

♣ 10 7 3

♠ Q 9 6 2

♥ 9 5 2

♦ K 9

♣ 9 8 6 2

NORTH has an opening hand, 15 points, and a 5-card ♠ suit. Unfortunately WEST beat her to the punch by opening 1♥.

But NORTH should get into the bidding anyway, by Overcalling 1♠. This shows a good ♠ suit and somewhere between 9 and 16 points.

SOUTH has 6 points. If NORTH had actually OPENED 1♠, SOUTH would be obligated to bid. But knowing that the Overcall will not be made with more than 16 points, SOUTH just passes.

West

1♥

North

1♠

*East**South*

All Pass

1♠ by North

Board 2

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q 9 6 2

♥ 10 5 2

♦ K Q 4

♣ K J 6

♠ 5 3

♥ Q 6 4 3

♦ 10 5 3 2

♣ A 10 9



♠ A K J 7 4

♥ 8 7

♦ A 7 6

♣ Q 5 4

♠ 10 8

♥ A K J 9

♦ J 9 8

♣ 8 7 3 2

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♥

1 ♠

Pass

2 ♠

Pass

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by East

EAST has an opening hand, 15 points and five ♠s. But NORTH beat him to the punch, so he overcalls 1 ♠.

WEST has 11 points, and if EAST had opened she would make a Limit Raise to 3 ♠.

But when replying to an Overcall, the strength needs to be a little higher. In Deal 1 it was OK to pass a 1 ♠ Overcall with 6 points, here it is correct to just raise to 2 ♠ with 11 points.

EAST actually has a strong Overcall so he bids 4 ♠.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 5 3
 ♥ A K J 3
 ♦ Q 10 3 2
 ♣ A 9 3

♠ Q 9 6 2

♥ 10 5 2

♦ A K

♣ K 8 6 2



♠ 10 8
 ♥ Q 9 6 4
 ♦ J 8 5 4
 ♣ Q 10 7

♠ A K J 7 4

♥ 8 7

♦ 9 7 6

♣ J 5 4

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

3♠

All Pass

3♠ by South

1♥

1♠

This time SOUTH has just 10 points, nowhere near an opening hand. Still, when EAST opens 1♥ SOUTH should Overcall 1♠. This shows a good ♠ suit and somewhere between 9 and 16 points.

NORTH has 13 points. If SOUTH had actually OPENED 1♠, NORTH would insist on game. But SOUTH didn't Open, she just Overcalled. So NORTH must be more cautious. He jumps to 3♠ and SOUTH shows her minimum type hand by passing.

Board 4

North Deals

Both Vul

♠ A 10 5 3

♥ 10 7 5

♦ Q 8

♣ A 8 6 2

♠ 7 4 2

♥ Q 9 8 2

♦ 9 6 4 2

♣ J 10



♠ K 9 8 6

♥ 4

♦ A K 7 3

♣ K Q 7 5

♠ Q J

♥ A K J 6 3

♦ J 10 5

♣ 9 4 3

*West**North**East**South*

2 ♠

1 ♥

Dbl

Pass

Pass

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by West

EAST has 15 points, a singleton in the opponent's suit and 4-card support for any suit partner might name. In other words, a perfect Takeout Double.

WEST needs to make a medium-strong bid to apprise EAST of her 10 points. She jumps to 2 ♠.

EAST's hand is now worth 17 points because of the singleton. Since he is quite happy with ♠s he bids 4 ♠.